Nicholas Rode

Product & Interactive Motion Designer

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SUMMARY

Product and interactive motion designer with 5+ years of experience shipping Rive and Lottie work for AI and data companies like Deepgram, Materialize, and Shep. I design motion that explains products, and I build AI tools that get it into production.

SKILLS

Motion & interaction: Rive (state machines, interactive components), After Effects, Lottie/Bodymovin, UI animation, 2D/3D animation, compositing

Design: Figma, Illustrator, UI/UX design, design systems, interactive prototyping

Production & performance: Rive web runtimes (React, Canvas, WebGL2), Lottie JSON delivery, WebGL shaders, Lighthouse performance tuning, reduced-motion accessibility, developer handoff

AI & building: Claude Code, AI-assisted tool building, Figma plugin development

EXPERIENCE

Motion Designer, Webstacks — Jan 2025 – Present

B2B web design and development agency

- Built 4 interactive Rive product demos for Deepgram's AI voice platform: voice-to-text, voice avatars, assistant states, and a Slack integration walkthrough
- Designed a 10-piece Rive animation system for Shep's rebrand, turning automation, security, and scale into one visual language
- Created scroll-driven Lottie animations for Materialize that show live data moving through the product
- Choose and optimize animation runtimes for mobile web performance
- Ship production Rive state machines with reduced-motion support and cross-device playback

Junior Designer (Product UI & Motion), Variable Medium — Jan 2021 – Dec 2024

- Designed the desktop and mobile peer-to-peer trading app for Evaluate, from interactive prototypes for user testing through launch, plus its marketing site and onboarding video
- Designed trade and chat flows, including asynchronous offers with expiry dates so traders don't need to be online at the same time
- Built advanced interactive prototypes for user testing and developer handoff
- Contributed to design system development and created motion that clarified complex product flows

Freelance Motion Designer & Illustrator, Self-employed — Jul 2024 – Present

- Deliver motion graphics, illustration, and web and mobile design for tech, SaaS, and B2B clients

TOOLS I'VE BUILT

Sequence to Shader: An AI-built pipeline that converts After Effects renders into lightweight WebGL shaders with measured accuracy, delivered as a drop-in module for developers.

Figma → React: A Figma plugin that generates reliable React code from designs, reducing design-to-code drift.

EDUCATION

Art Institute of Seattle

Nucamp, Full Stack Web Design 2020

COURSES

Rive Masterclass

TheMotionMagic, Ultimate Rive Animation Course

School of Motion, A Motion Design Masterpiece